

Tentative Rulings
June 26, 2026
Department S-17
Judge Joseph Ortiz

Tentative Rulings for Department S-17 are posted on the court's website (<https://www.sb-court.org/divisions/civil/civil-tentative-rulings>) at 3:00 p.m. or at 7:00 p.m. the court day before the hearing. If no tentative ruling is posted at 3:00 p.m., please check again after 7:00 p.m.

If you do not wish to submit on a tentative ruling, you must appear for the hearing either in person, via CourtCall (888-882-6878 or www.courtcall.com), or by ZOOM. Failure to appear is deemed a waiver of oral argument. If all parties submit on a tentative ruling, it will become the ruling of the court. The tentative ruling may note particular issues on which the court requests the parties to provide further argument at the hearing. If so directed, attendance at the hearing is mandatory. The party prevailing on a motion or other hearing shall serve written notice of the court's ruling unless all parties waive notice of the ruling.

ATTENTION: Since January 9, 2023, the Court no longer provides an official Court Reporter to transcribe proceedings in this Department. Parties who wish to have an official record of the proceedings in addition to a minute order must retain a private Certified Shorthand Reporter for the hearing and must submit a "Stipulation and Order to Use Certified Shorthand Reporter." Parties who do not retain a Certified Shorthand Reporter to be designated as an official Court Reporter Pro Tempore are deemed to have waived an official Court Reporter for the proceeding.

UNLESS OTHERWISE NOTED, THE PREVAILING PARTY IS TO GIVE NOTICE OF THE RULING.

12. *Saldana v. Fiber Care Baths, Inc., et al*, Case No. CIVSB2418960
Defendant's Motion for Protective Order
6/26/26, 9:00 a.m., Dept. S-17

Tentative Rulings

As to Requests for Judicial Notice: The Court would **GRANT** notice as to the notice of entry and order approving the class action settlement in case CIVDS2114736; the First Amended Complaint in this case; the joint further CMC statement filed on October 24, 2025; and the joint IDC brief filed on December 8, 2025.

As to the Motion: The Court would deem the motion **MOOT** in like to the apparent withdrawal of the prior discovery via the new discovery. The parties should meet-and-confer to the extent additional issues remain.

Given the agreement to amend the scope of the class and some apparent shortfalls with the meet-and-confer process, no sanctions are warranted in favor of either party.

Case Summary

This is a putative wage-and-hour class and representative action. Plaintiff seeks to represent similarly situated employees and alleges they were subject to various Labor Code violations in connection with their employment at Defendant Fiber Care. Plaintiff first filed his suit on June 7, 2024. The operative First Amended Complaint (FAC) alleges violations relating to (1) minimum wages; (2) overtime; (3) meal periods; (4) rest breaks; (5) reimbursements; (6) wage timeliness; (7) accurate wage statements; as well as causes for (8) violation of the unfair competition law (UCL); and (9) civil penalties pursuant to the Private Attorneys General Act (PAGA).

Statement of the Law

"The court, for good cause shown, may make any order that justice requires to protect any party or other person from unwarranted annoyance, embarrassment, or oppression, or undue burden and expense." (Code of Civ. Proc., § 2031.060(b).) More specifically, Code of Civil Procedure section 2031.060(a), provides that when an inspection or copying of documents or electronically stored information has been demanded, the party to whom the demand has been directed, and any other party or affected person, may promptly move for a protective order.

Analysis

As for the merits of the motion, in the opposition Plaintiff concedes that the class period should be limited from October 22, 2022, onward and that he proposed that amendment to the FAC. Plaintiff also contends he attempted to re-notice the deposition with the revised class period in addition to serving new Special Interrogatories (SROGs) and Requests for Production (RFP) on March 16, 2026, in order to limit the discovery. (Opp., 6:1-6.) In this regard, and to the extent

that the additional discovery serves to supersede the prior requests, the motion appears moot because the prior discovery has been effectively withdrawn. Otherwise, the concession by Plaintiff appears to support the issuance of a protective order since, if nothing else, the written discovery is largely dependent upon the “relevant time period” that predates the prior settlement or, alternatively, the discovery references the “class members,” a term which also appears to include the same temporal reference, though that is not true as to every single discovery request.

13. *Novalk, LLC v. Cirit, et al*, Case No. CIVSB2122277
Defendant’s Motion for Attorneys’ Fees
6/26/26, 9:00 a.m., Dept. S-17

Tentative Ruling

The Court would **AWARD** reasonable attorneys’ fees in the amount of \$191,250.00 to Defendants.

Summary of the Law

Generally, attorneys’ fees are borne by each party. (Code Civ. Proc., § 1021; *Pederson v. Kennedy* (1982) 128 Cal.App.3d 976, 978-79.) Nonetheless, attorneys’ fees are recoverable in litigation when authorized by contract, statute, or law. (Code Civ. Proc., §1033.5, subd. (a)(10).) Here, it is undisputed that the Declaration of Restrictions that encumbers all parties’ property provides for attorney fees when sued on the Declaration.

Analysis

Relevant here, after a three-day bench trial in late October of 2025, the Court granted Defendants’ motion for judgment pursuant to Code of Civil Procedure section 631.8 and ordered judgment entered in Defendants’ favor. Now, before the Court, is Defendants’ motion for attorneys’ fees.

Plaintiff argues that under the catalyst theory, it can be deemed the prevailing party because it obtained the objectives of its allegations by Defendants foregoing its claim that Defendant S. Cirit had the right and authority to manage the Shopping Center [FAC, ¶132]; foregoing seeking to extract improper maintenance fees [FAC, ¶132]; removing the blockage to the east access side of the Shopping Center [FAC, ¶135]; and removing any parking restrictions. (FAC, ¶134.) These changes occurred while this case was pending.

Under the catalyst theory, a plaintiff can recover fees if it “establish[es] that (1) the lawsuit was a catalyst motivating the defendants to provide the primary relief sought; (2) that the lawsuit had merit and achieved its catalytic effect by threat of victory, not by dint of nuisance and

threat of expense, as elaborated in *Graham*; and, (3) that the plaintiffs reasonably attempted to settle the litigation prior to filing the lawsuit.” (*Tipton-Whittingham v. City of Los Angeles* (2004) 34 Cal.4th 604, 608.)

However, here, Defendants seek contractually-permitted attorney fees. They are not relying on any statute for the right to be held the prevailing party and entitled to recover attorneys’ fees associated with the tort claims. Thus, even if the Court considers the catalyst theory, Plaintiff submits no evidence to support its contention that Defendant changed its position on the primary relief sought within the FAC; that Defendants changed their position because Plaintiff’s contentions had merit; and/or that Plaintiff attempted to resolve the issues before the lawsuit was filed.

Also, under Code of Civil Procedure section 1021.5, the entitlement to attorneys’ fees exists if a significant benefit was conferred on the general public or a large class of persons. (*Sweetwater Union High School Dist. v. Julian Union Elementary School Dist.* (2019) 36 Cal.App.5th 970, 980.) Here, Plaintiff does not demonstrate the alleged changes affect any large class of persons. Rather, by all implication, it affected Plaintiff only or, perhaps, a small group of owners within the at issue shopping center.

The Reasonableness of Fees – In determining the fees, the goal is to determine a reasonable fee. (*Chavez v. City of Los Angeles* (2010) 47 Cal.4th 970, 985.) This is done by applying the lodestar method. (Civ. Code, § 1794(d); *Chavez, supra*, 47 Cal.4th at p. 985.) The Court can reduce the hours that appear unreasonably inflated. (*Chavez, supra*, 47 Cal.4th at p. 990.) Additionally, inefficient or duplicative efforts are not subject to compensation. (*Ketchum v. Moses* (2001) 24 Cal.4th 1122, 1132.) The burden is on the party seeking attorney fees to prove the fees are reasonable. (*Goglin v. VMW of North America, LLC* (2016) 4 Cal.App.5th 462, 470.)

Here, Defendants seek to recover \$203,625 in attorneys’ fees, which is based on 452.5 hours of services between September 2021 and December 2025. With the supplemental brief, Defendant seek to recover an additional \$15,000, which is based on 33.3 more hours.

As a starting point, the parties do not contest the reasonableness of Defendants’ attorneys’ rate. Thus, we look to whether the allocated time is reasonable:

Additional Fees: The problem with the requested additional \$15,000 in fees is three-fold. First, the request is made without providing Plaintiff an opportunity to respond. Second, the additional fees relate to matters associated with the appeal. It is premature to recover fees related to the appeal. Defendants may be able to recover the fees for the appeal, but it will rest on whether the judgment is affirmed. Third, although the additional fees also relate to work on the attorneys’ fee motion and attending the hearing, Defendants needed to identify the fees sought associated with that work in their moving papers so Plaintiff could have the opportunity to respond. Although the motion stated it would seek those fees, it made no offer of what the estimated fee would be. Although a reply or supplemental brief could provide more exact

quantification of the work on the attorneys' fee motion after its filing, the moving papers should still give the opposing side an idea of the fees that would be sought. Based on the above, none of the \$15,000 additional fees are recoverable.

Original Fees: As Defendants' right to attorneys' fees rests on a contract, the fees are limited to only those on the contract action. (*Santisas v. Goodin* (1998) 17 Cal.4th 599, 615.) This litigation encompassed contractual and tort claims. Thus, the fees recoverable should only be those for work on the contractual claims.

Nonetheless, fees need not be apportioned between distinct causes of action when the claims involve a common core of facts or are based on related legal theories. (*Brown Bark III, L.P. v. Haver* (2013) 219 Cal.App.4th 809, 829.) The standard is that fee apportionment is not necessary when the claims are so intertwined that it would be impractical, if not impossible, to separate the attorney's time into compensable and non-compensable units. (*Id.* at pp. 829-830.) Whether to apportion fees is within the trial court's sound discretion. (*Brown Bark, supra*, 219 Cal.App.4th at p. 830.) Here, after reviewing the records, there are none that can be ascertained to clearly relate only to any tort claim and, thus, subject to apportionment and cutting.

However, there are three categories that are not warranted: (1) travel; (2) secretarial tasks; and (3) unreasonable.

- a. Travel – Although travel for the mediation, trial, and in-person trial readiness conference would be reasonably incurred, the following travel entries are for hearings that Counsel could have appeared via ZOOM or Court Call: 10/19/21 (ex parte hearing); 11/15/21 (preliminary injunction); 12/2/21 (preliminary injunction); 1/27/22 (strike motion); 4/6/22 (strike motion); 4/28/22 (strike motion); 8/17/22 (discovery motions); 3/12/25 (hearing on Novalk's legal representation); and 5/1/25 (OSC re Novalk's representation). Now, these entries include time for the actual appearance and preparing notices of ruling.
- b. Secretarial – Although attorney fees may include paralegal (or law clerk) fees, it generally does not include secretary or receptionist fees. (See, e.g., *Mountjoy v. Bank of America, N.A.* (2016) 245 Cal.App.4th 266, 270 [re non-attorney work].)

Here, the Court finds entries on 12/1/21; 10/31/22; 1/17/24; 8/13/25; 11/1/25; 11/28/25; and 12/3/25, to be more consistent with such secretarial or receptionist work. The Court would cut a total of 4.25 hours (\$1,912.50 in the requested fees) as non-compensable.

- c. Unreasonable – The following five entries related to matters that appear unreasonable:
- i. 12/13/21, 12/15/21, & 12/24/21: For review, revise, and communicate on the gate automation system and cessation of C-Tech’s maintenance services – 1.5 hours, 1 hour, and 1 hour. As discussed above, Plaintiff alleged in the FAC that Defendants improperly denied access on the east side of the Shopping Center and recovered maintenance fees through C-Tech. These entries indicate the agreement to stop such activities, which is a “win” for Plaintiff. Thus, the 3.5 hours for this work should not be incurred by Plaintiff.
 - ii. 11/25/24 & 11/26/24: Review email regarding a City Code Enforcement Notice for 1.5 hours, and review of C-Tech’s invoices to NC Queen for 0.25 hours. This litigation did not concern Code Enforcement matters. It is further unclear the reasonableness of reviewing invoices to NC Queen. Nothing in these entries appears relevant to the litigation to then require Plaintiff to cover those costs. Thus, the 1.75 hours for these entries should be cut.

The above totals 5.25 hours or \$2,362.50 in fees.

The total proposed cuts are \$12,375. Reducing that from the amount sought provides for an award of \$191,250 in attorneys’ fees.

14. *Baker, et al, v. Chaffey Joint Union HSD., et al*, Case No. CIVSB2128630 (CIVSB2134233)
Motion for Class Certification
6/26/26, 9:00 a.m., Dept. S-17

This matter has been continued from its prior May 4, 2026, hearing date

Tentative Rulings

As to Requests for Judicial Notice: With its opposition and its *supplemental* opposition, the District requests notice of the Government Claims filed by Baker and Doe. (Exhs. 1-2.) The Court would **DENY** (both the requests filed on April 12, 2026 and on June 15, 2026) because they are irrelevant to the issues on a motion for certification.

As to Objections: The District further files seven evidentiary objections to the Linder Declaration. The Court would **SUSTAIN** number two relating to a criminal report (hearsay and relevance) but **OVERRULE** as to the remainder.

As to Class Certification:

The Court would **DENY** as to Plaintiffs Baker, Doe, and ML's motion for certification of Baker/Doe's 5th cause and ML's 5th cause [re Civil Code, § 1708.85] because they fail to establish typicality (e.g., that intimate images of them were distributed).

The Court would **GRANT** Plaintiffs Baker, Doe, and ML's motion as follows: (1) Baker/Doe's 1st and 2nd causes and ML's 2nd, 3rd, and 4th causes [re District negligence]; (2) Baker/Doe's 3rd, 4th, and 6th causes and ML's 1st cause [re invasion of privacy and intentional infliction of emotional distress].

The Court would **CERTIFY** the class of "All female students who attended Los Osos High School from August 1, 2016, to August 24, 2021, who were enrolled in female physical education classes and/or involved in female athletics programs."

The Court would **APPOINT** Plaintiffs Baker, Doe, and ML as class representatives and attorneys Jason Hartley and Jason Linder of Hartley LLP; Daniel Karon of Karon LLC; and Kashif Haque, Samuel Wong, and Ali Carlsen of Aegis Law Firm, PC, as Class Counsel.

The Court would **ORDER** the parties to meet and confer by July 3, 2026, on class notice of the certification, with the Class Notice to be mailed/ emailed and provide the 30-day opt-out period no later than July 17, 2026.

The Court would **ORDER** Plaintiffs to submit an order on the class certification no later than July 2, 2026, with a physical courtesy copy provided to this department.

Case Summary

At essence, this is a putative class action for invasion of privacy. In this matter, Plaintiffs seek to represent female students who attended Los Osos High School, located within Defendant School District (District) during the time that Defendant Riden, who was a locker room attendant and assistant coach, placed at least one hidden camera in the girls' bathroom.

The original Complaint was filed on October 8, 2021, but a First Amended Complaint (FAC) was filed as a matter of right on December 3, 2021. With the filing of her Second Amended Complaint (SAC) on August 26, 2023, Plaintiff Jane Roe was added, a minor through her guardian John Roe. The operative Third Amended Complaint (the "Baker TAC") was filed on March 1, 2023, pleading (1) negligence (against the District); (2) negligent hiring, retention & supervision (against the District); (3) common law invasion of privacy (against Riden); (4) Constitutional invasion of privacy (against the Riden); (5) violation of Section 1708.85 of the Civil Code (against Riden); and (6) IIED (against Riden).

Another class action against the District and Riden was filed by Plaintiff G.S. on December 14, 2021. A First Amended Complaint was filed on December 21, 2022, and a Second Amended Complaint (the "ML SAC"), was filed on March 8, 2023. In the ML SAC, Plaintiff G.S. was

replaced by M.L. Following a demurrer to the ML SAC, a Third Amended Complaint was filed on July 31, 2023 (the “ML TAC”). The District was successful on demurrer against the ML TAC on January 2, 2024. ML filed a Fourth Amended Complaint (the “ML 4AC”) on February 1, 2024. As currently stated, the ML 4AC now asserts (1) IIED; (2) negligence; (3) negligent supervision; (4) negligent hiring and retention; and (5) violation of Section 1708.85 of the Civil Code (against Riden). The Court again sustained a demurrer, this time without leave, as to the IIED cause of action. The two complaints were consolidated on February 14, 2023.

Summary of the Law

A trial court has great discretion in certifying class actions. (*Bell v. American Title Ins. Co.* (1991) 226 Cal.App.3d 1589, 1606.) In a motion for class certification, plaintiffs must demonstrate through substantial evidence that the proposed class is *ascertainable*; that its members are *numerous*; that the plaintiffs’ claims are *typical* of claims held by other class members; that plaintiffs and counsel can provide *adequate representation* for the class; and that *common questions of law or fact predominate* over the individual issues. (*Brinker Restaurant Corp. v. Superior Court* (2012) 53 Cal.4th 1004, 1021-1022.) Certifying a class action requires a demonstrated substantial benefit to litigants and court. (*Caro v. Proctor & Gamble Co.* (1993) 18 Cal.App.4th 644, 657.) The burden of this demonstration rests with plaintiff. (*Collins v. Safeway Stores, Inc.* (1986) 187 Cal.App.3d 62.)

Analysis

Here, Plaintiffs Baker, Roe, and ML now move to certify the following class: “All female students who attended Los Osos High School from August 1, 2016, to August 24, 2021, who were enrolled in female physical education classes and/or involved in female athletics programs.” Defendant District opposes.

As a preliminary matter, the District largely challenges the merits of Plaintiffs’ claims of negligence. However, the question of certification is essentially a procedural one that does not ask whether the action is legally or factually meritorious. (*Sav-On Drugs Store, Inc. v. Superior Court* (2004) 34 Cal.4th 319, 326.) Rather, “the focus in a certification dispute is on what type of questions – common or individual – are likely to arise in the action, rather than on the merits of the case [citation], in determining whether there is substantial evidence to support a . . . certification order . . .” (*Id.* at p. 327.)

Numerosity & Ascertainability: As to the relevant standards, the Court will start by indicating that it appears that Plaintiffs have established *numerosity* and *ascertainability*: As to *numerosity*, substantial evidence establishes 3,300 female students who were sent *Belaire West* notices. While the Court considers the District’s assertion that this is a total number of female students, even if ten percent of the 3,300 individuals accessed the locker room and pool storage area, the class would consist of 330, which is still numerous. As to *ascertainability*, the ability to identify female students at Los Osos given the proposed time period exists, as was demonstrated by the *Belaire West* notice. (Pl. Exh. N.) As to those within the female student

body who entered the locker room, certainly students can self-determine if they were enrolled in a PE class or an athletic program.

Typicality: The named plaintiff must be a member of the class. (*Petherbridge v. Altadena Federal Savings and Loan Assc.* (1974) 37 Cal.App.3d 193, 200.) The test of typicality is “whether other members have the same or similar injury, whether the action is based on conduct which is not unique to the named plaintiffs, and whether other class members have been injured by the same course of conduct.” (*Seastrom v. Neways, Inc.* (2007) 149 Cal.App.4th 1496, 1502.) However, the class representative’s interests need not be identical to those of class members, only similarly situated. (*Classen v. Weller* (1983) 145 Cal.App.3d 27, 46.)

Here, Plaintiffs Baker, Roe, and ML attest that they were students at Los Osos between August 2014 and May 2018, August 2019 and May 2021, and August 2016 and August 2021, respectively. (Baker & Roe Decls., ¶12 [Exhs. 1-2 to Lander’s Decl.]; ML Decl., ¶13 [Exh. A to Carlsen’s Decl.].) Baker attests that she was on the dance team and played volleyball during her time at Los Osos, and took PE. She would enter the bathroom in the locker room off the pool a minimum of once every school day. She would also be present in the locker room once per day for the two years she took PE, and once per day for the three years she was on the dance team. (Baker Decl., ¶¶12-3 [Exh. 1 to Linder’s Decl.].) Doe, for her part, attests that she participated in track and field during her freshman and sophomore years. She had PE in her sophomore year. She regularly used the locker room and bathroom a number of times during the swim portion of the PE class. (Doe Decl., ¶13 [Exh. 2 to Linder’s Decl.].) ML attests that she was enrolled in PE classes. During her freshman year, she participated in track and field. During her sophomore, junior, and senior years, she was on the cheer team. She was assigned a locker in the locker room for PE in her freshman and sophomore years. She would use the locker room to change every day for practice and games when on the cheer team. She would use the restroom when taking PE or cheering at water polo games. (ML Decl., ¶¶13-4 [Exh. A to Carlsen’s Decl.].)

These declarations are sufficient to establish that Plaintiffs were students at Los Osos within the class period (August 2016-August 2021). They further sufficiently establish that Plaintiffs used the girls’ locker room and restroom associated with being enrolled in PE or engaging in athletic programs. Thus, they share with the class claims in that they had the reasonable expectation of privacy associated with the bathroom and locker room violated by the placement of a camera by Riden. (See, e.g., CACI 1800.) Further, the camera’s placement in the sensitive location that was used by the Plaintiffs – whether the camera captured their images or not - could be viewed as outrageous conduct to support the cause for IIED. (See CACI 1600.)

However, Civil Code section 1708.85 imposes liability on one who distributes images of intimate body parts. Civil Code section 1708.85(a), expressly states the liability arises from the *distribution* of material that exposes another’s intimate body parts when know or should know that the other person had a reasonable expectation that the material would remain private. In other words, Riden can only be liable under this statute if he distributed his locker room images that exposed an intimate body part of the named Plaintiffs and the putative class members.

Plaintiffs admit that they are unaware of any pictures or videos obtained by Riden that capture their images. (Def's Exh. 2-4 [Baker & Roe's RFA Responses #1, 5, & 9; ML's RFA Responses #2, 4-5, & 13].)

Therefore, Plaintiffs are typical with the putative class relating to the negligence claims against Defendant District and the privacy invasion and IIED claims against Riden [TAC's 1st-4th and 6th and 4AC's 1st-4th], but they lack typicality by their own admissions to a Civil Code section 1708.85 claim [TAC's 5th and 4AC's 5th].

Adequacy: Adequacy consists of two factors: (1) adequacy of the proposed class representative, and (2) adequacy of the proposed class counsel. Here, while counsel appears to have established adequate experience and skill. However, again, Plaintiffs Baker, Doe, and ML fail to submit a declaration attesting to their understanding of their role as class representatives and their lack of conflict. Thus, adequacy is not established.

Common Questions: Plaintiffs allege the District is liable for negligent failure to protect Los Osos female students and the negligent hiring, retention, and supervision of Riden.

Plaintiffs present expert reports where an expert stated that voyeurism involving non-consenting individuals, particularly minors, is recognized in literature as a form of sexual victimization. Thus, they expect that being exposed to image-based sexual abuse will result in a psychological impact on all affected adolescents. The common impact includes emotional and psychological effects (shame, humiliation, anxiety, fear, sadness, anger, betrayal, etc.), trauma-related symptoms (intrusive thoughts, avoidance, sleep disturbances, etc.), development and social effects (disruption in body images and bodily autonomy, social withdrawal, etc.), and academic and school functioning. (Pls. Exh. O.) The failure to provide sufficient protection leading to voyeurism is a foreseeable harm. The harm arises even if no images are recovered of any particular person or are unable to identify those in the images, because it comes from the intrusion into one's privacy and sense of safety. (Pls. Exh. P.)

Plaintiffs further indicate the damages sought under the negligence claims against the District are limited to costs for crisis counseling and health services. Chou opines that when the camera was discovered, the District should have provided immediate psychological first aid, ongoing crisis support through private counseling and implemented a student protection department. She further opines on the comparative cost for each of these. (Pls. Exh. P.) Similarly, an economic expert evaluates the cost for comparative services under a willingness-to-pay methodology. (Pls. Exh. Q.) By limiting the recoverable damages to economic factors that can be quantified and seeking to show that generalized harm can result in exposing females to voyeurism, the elements of causation and damages can be established on a common basis. Therefore, commonality is demonstrated predominating on the claims against the District.

17. *Shepard v. People 2.0 North America LLC, et al*, Case No. CIVSB2221511
Plaintiff's Motion for Preliminary Approval of Class Action Settlement
4/16/26, 1:30 p.m., Dept. S-17

This matter was continued from its original hearing date on April 16, 2026

The Court would again **CONTINUE** this matter. The settlement in this matter seeks to incorporate the parties and causes from the PAGA companionate case in the CIVSB2301269. The two matters have *not* been consolidated nor has the instant case (CIVSB2221511) been amended to sufficiently cover all the causes covered in the settlement. (See Second Amended Complaint [with no articulation of a PAGA cause].)

Case law requires that the releases be tailored to the claims that were, or reasonably could have been, asserted in the lawsuit based on the facts alleged in the operative complaint (and, in PAGA cases, the notice letter to the LWDA). (See, e.g., *Amaro v. Anaheim Arena Management, LLC* (2021) 69 Cal.App.5th 521, 538-539 ["a court cannot release claims that are outside the scope of the allegations of the complaint"].) As currently pleaded, the operative complaint does not contain a PAGA cause. Thus, a consolidation of the CIVSB2301269 matter, *or* a Third Amended Complaint that adds the PAGA cause in *this* matter, is necessary. The Court would continue again in order to allow the movant to resolve this concern.
